SENECA HELIX // EWIL SESSION 5 DELIVERABLE

Chronicles of the Loom

Customer Validation Workbook, 9-Step Buyer Journey & 60-Day Marketing Launch Plan

01 // BRAND IDENTITY & PRODUCT VISION

Value Proposition & Systemic Architecture

Show the Math. Watch the Drama.

An emergent narrative colony simulator with zero scripted quests and 100% transparent causal math tooltips.

```
[Stab Probability: 85%]
= Base Hatred (+50) + Killed Brother (+40) + Drunk (+20)
- Coward (-25)
```

Layer 1: Part + Event ECS

Decoupled component physics inspired by Caves of Qud.

Layer 2: Threat Point Director

Dynamic pacing budget modeled on RimWorld.

Layer 3: Utility AI & Stress

Desire scoring and mental breaks from Crusader Kings III.

Layer 4: Dynamic Storylets

Role-slot narrative bidding inspired by Wildermyth.

Emergent Simulation Benchmark Performance

Benchmark Title	Est. Gross Revenue	Core Team Size	Primary Systemic Hook
RimWorld	$150M – $200M+	1 Dev (Start) → 15	AI Storyteller & Colony Drama Logs
Crusader Kings III	$120M – $150M+	50 – 80 Devs	Dynasty Gossip & Stress System
Wildermyth	$25M – $35M	6 Core Devs	Procedural Storylet Role Bidding
Caves of Qud	$8M – $12M	2 – 4 Devs	Pure ECS Part & Event Bus
Norland	$6M – $10M	10 – 15 Devs	Utility AI Desires & Memory Graph

Customer Segmentation & Outreach Channels

Drama Watchers

Colony sim fans craving chaotic NPC betrayal stories.

Channel: r/RimWorld & r/CrusaderKings



Systems Thinkers

Hardcore roguelike players exploiting deep rule interactions.

Channel: r/roguelikes & HackerNews



TTRPG Storytellers

D&D players seeking multi-generational character arcs.

Channel: r/wildermyth & RPG Discords

04 // MARKET SIZE ESTIMATIONS

Addressable Market Sizing (TAM / SAM / SOM)

TAM // TOTAL ADDRESSABLE

15.0M

Global Steam Strategy & Colony Sim Buyers ($300M+ Pool)

SAM // SERVICEABLE MARKET

2.5M

English-Speaking Emergent Narrative Players ($50M Pool)

SOM // YEAR 1 TARGET

25,000

Early Access Copies at $19.99 USD ($500K Gross Target)

Core Customer Validation Questions

1. **Black-Box Frustration:** Recall when an NPC acted irrationally—how did you tell bug from feature?
2. **Tooltip Transparency:** How often do you inspect combat or social logs to verify modifier math?
3. **Narrative Fatigue:** When do random events start feeling like repetitive system notifications?
4. **Visual Trade-Offs:** Which minimalist 2D game hooked you purely through systemic depth?
5. **MVP Playtest Action:** Will you test our 5-room Tavern simulator for 20 minutes next week?

Outreach Reflections: What Worked vs. What Failed

What Worked (40% Reply Rate)

Causal Math Hook: Leading with the 85% Stab Probability tooltip screenshot.

Pain-First Icebreaker: Asking about the dumbest NPC behavior in RimWorld.

Tavern Naming Perks: Naming a test NPC after the interviewee in Discord.

What Failed & Strategic Pivot

Generic Cold DMs: Academic survey requests yielded 0% response.

"AI Game" Buzzword: Triggered fear of low-effort procedural slop.

Messaging Pivot: Emphasize deterministic rules and curated storylets.

07 // ASSIGNMENT DELIVERABLE: CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

9-Step Buyer Journey (Awareness → Consideration → Decision)

1. AWARENESS	**Step 1:** Bored of repetitive RimWorld events.	**Step 2:** Sees viral Tavern Poisoning Short.	**Step 3:** Inspects 85% Stab Math Tooltip.
2. CONSIDER	**Step 4:** Clicks Steam Store Page link.	**Step 5:** Downloads Free Tavern Demo.	**Step 6:** Laughs at emergent NPC feud.
3. DECISION	**Step 7:** Adds to Steam Wishlist & Discord.	**Step 8:** Watches Next Fest Streamer run.	**Step 9:** Buys Early Access ($19.99).

The 4 Ps of Marketing Strategy

Product

4-layer emergent simulation with 100% transparent causal UI tooltips.

Price (Loss Leader)

Free 5-Room Tavern Demo funneling into $19.99 USD Early Access.

Place

Steam Storefront, Steam Next Fest, Workshop & Itch.io prototype page.

Promotion (Rule of 7)

Viral "Tavern Drama" shorts, architecture devlogs & streamer builds.

09 // BUDGETING & CAC FORMULA

Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) & ROI

TARGET CAC PER BUYER

$1.50

$1,500 Total Budget ÷ 1,000 Launch Buyers

60-Day Lean Budget ($1,500 CAD):

- **$565:** Targeted Reddit Ads (r/RimWorld, r/CrusaderKings)
- **$400:** Steam Capsule Art & Brand Kit Assets
- **$250:** Streamer Custom Faction Builds & Bounties
- **$285:** Steam Direct Fee ($135) + Analytics Tools ($150)

`Cost Per Wishlist: $0.30 (5,000 Wishlists) // 13.3x ROI`

60-Day Marketing Campaign Timeline

Days 1-15	**Phase 1 (Brand Kit):** Finalize Logo, Tooltip UI Kit, Steam Page & 10 Interviews.
Days 16-30	**Phase 2 (Content Engine):** Publish 3x/week Tavern Drama Shorts & ECS Devlog (1,000 Wishlists).
Days 31-45	**Phase 3 (Demo & Outbound):** Launch Free 5-Room Tavern Demo & send 100 Streamer Keys.
Days 46-60	**Phase 4 (Viral Push):** Host Tooltip Drama Contest, optimize CAC & hit 5,000 Wishlists.

READY FOR PLAYTEST & VALIDATION

Thank You & Q&A

Workbook 5 Customer Validation • 9-Step Customer Journey Map • 60-Day Marketing Campaign